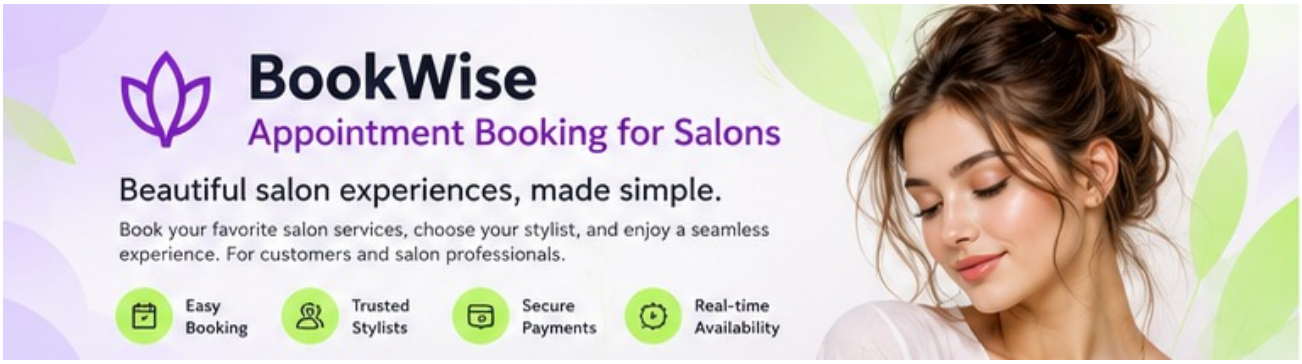
BOOKWISE

Salon Appointment Booking Website

Complete full-stack project guide | Easy English | Free-tier-first approach







Project goal: A salon website where customers can browse services, choose a stylist, select an available time, and book in minutes. Salon staff can manage services, calendars, customers, and appointment statuses.

Design inspiration: Your four uploaded salon, beauty, and mobile booking references. Mockups in this guide are original concept illustrations, not working website screenshots.

Important: A free-tier setup means no required software subscription at the start. It does not mean unlimited hosting, free custom domains, or free online payment processing.

01 / Project at a glance

One salon, multiple services, one shared schedule.

Problems BookWise solves

- Customers should not have to call or message just to ask about times.
- Staff should not need to compare multiple chats and calendars.
- Two customers must never secure the same stylist at overlapping times.
- Customers should be able to cancel or reschedule within salon rules.

Three kinds of users

Role	What they can do
Guest / Customer	View services and prices. Sign up, book, view and manage own appointments.
Stylist / Staff	See assigned appointments and approved working hours; update allowed booking statuses.
Salon Admin	Manage staff, services, schedules, blocked time, customers, policies and all bookings.

Project boundaries (Version 1)

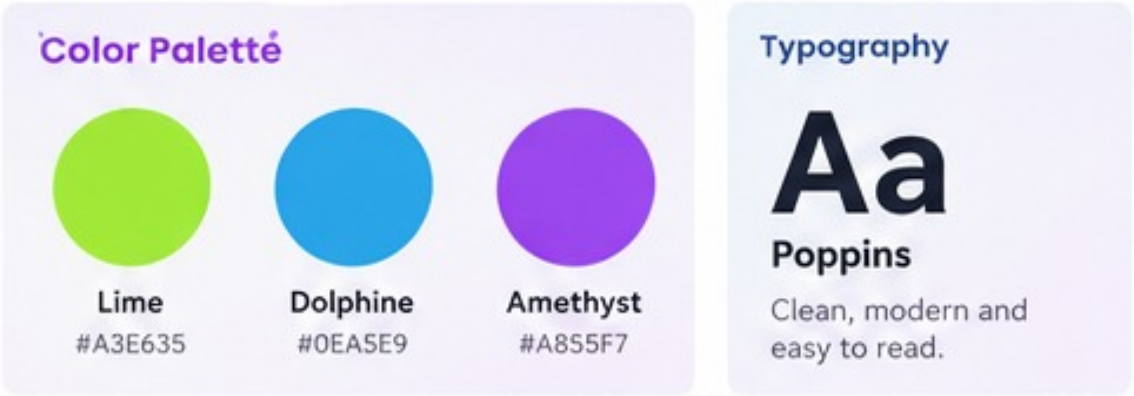
Build for **one salon** only. Each service has a name, duration, price and eligible stylists. The platform supports one booking calendar with multiple stylists. Avoid marketplace features, subscriptions, AI, large video backgrounds and live chat in the first version.

Sample user story

A customer chooses Haircut (45 minutes), selects stylist A, clicks Friday at 3:00 PM, signs in, confirms the appointment and sees a booking receipt. Stylist A and the salon admin see the booking immediately after refreshing or loading their dashboard.

02 / Brand and UI design

Modern beauty website; elegant, fast and easy to navigate.



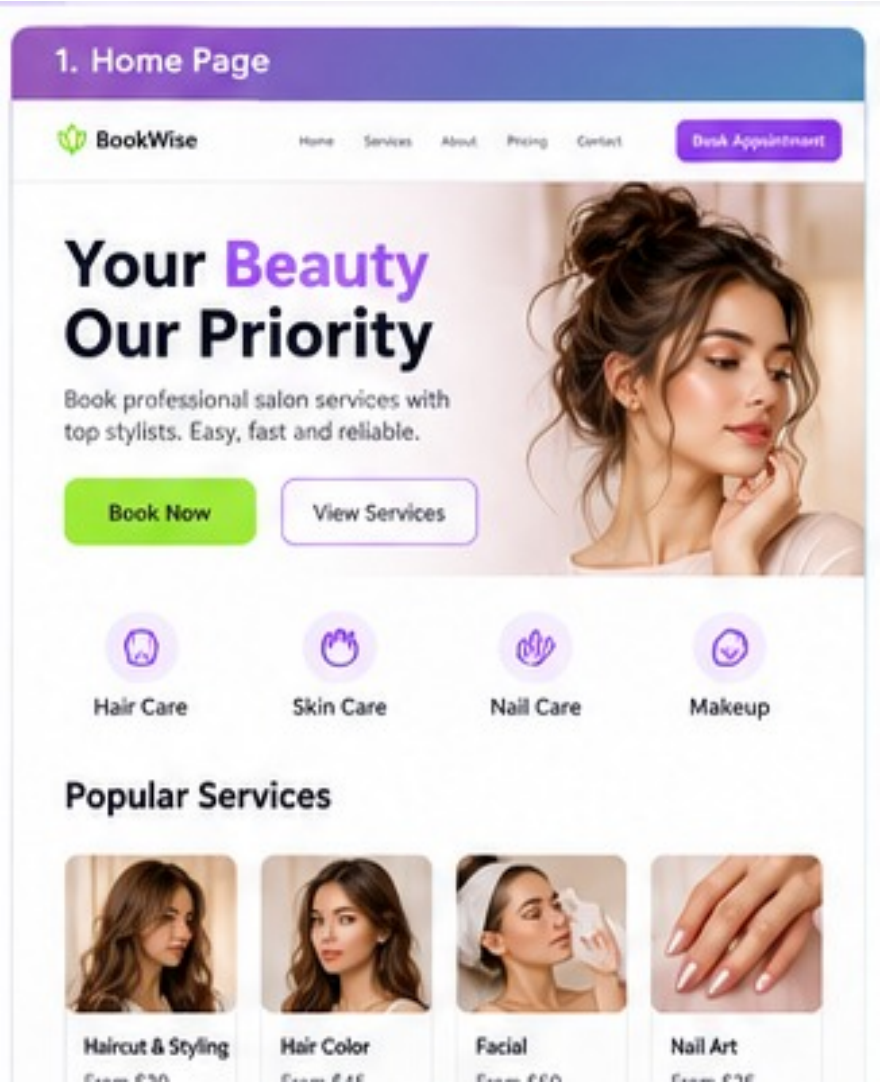
Design token	Suggested value	Where to use
Lime	#A3E635	Selected buttons, available slots, success states
Dolphin blue	#0EA5E9	Helpful links, icons, subtle highlights
Amethyst	#A855F7	Main action buttons, headers, active tabs
Ink	#181326	Primary text; high contrast
Off-white	#FBFAFE	Clean page background

Practical design rules

- Use white/off-white space generously, light borders and gently rounded cards.
- Use 1-2 fonts only: a modern sans serif for UI; optional display serif in the hero.
- Do not use lime for long body text; dark text on pale backgrounds is easier to read.
- Button labels should explain the action: “Book appointment”, “Confirm booking”.
- Design keyboard focus, clear field errors, empty states and loading states.
- Use optimized, permission-cleared salon photographs; avoid huge image sliders.

03 / Home page

Primary job: turn a visitor into a booking.



Include on the page

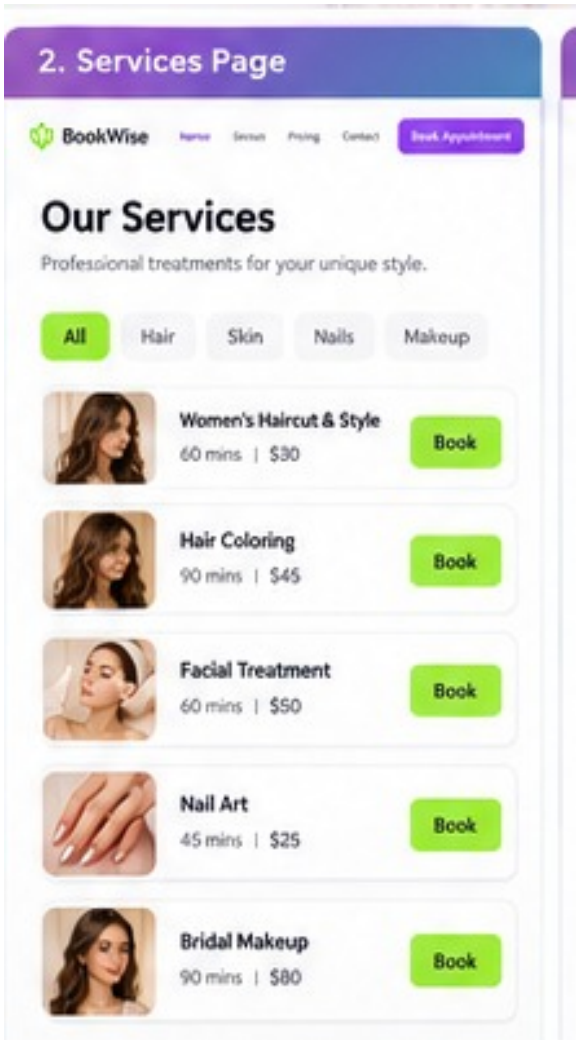
- Top bar: logo, Services, About, Gallery, Contact, Login and Book Appointment.
- Hero: one compressed salon image, simple headline and clear Book Now button.
- Quick category cards: hair, nails, makeup and skincare (only services the salon offers).
- Popular services with starting prices, durations and Book actions.
- Why choose us, verified reviews if real, opening hours and salon contact details.

Responsive behavior

On mobile, use a small menu, stacked hero text and image, two-column category tiles and one-column service cards. Keep the main booking button visible, without covering the screen.

04 / Services and stylist pages

Help customers make a choice without confusion.



Service details

For each service show its name, photo, price, length in minutes, short description, what is included, optional preparation notes and a Book button. If a service has an estimated price, explicitly say so.

Stylist profile

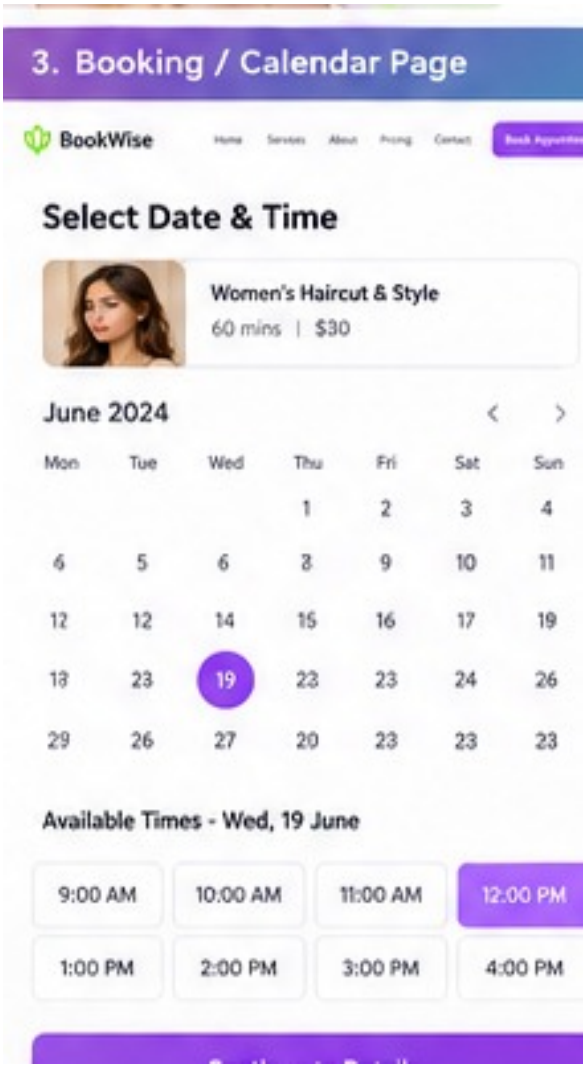
Show staff name, role, specialties, real photo (with consent), services offered, working hours, and genuine customer ratings only if reviews are implemented. Staff can be assigned only to services they perform.

Important rule

A service duration is used to calculate the **end time**. Example: 45-minute haircut beginning at 10:00 ends at 10:45. Apply cleanup/buffer time separately if the salon needs it.

05 / Booking calendar

A customer should see only bookable times.



Booking sequence

01. Choose a service and eligible stylist (or Any Available).

02. Choose a date, then fetch slots from the server.

03. Show only future times inside working hours, excluding breaks, closures and existing bookings.

04. Select one available time and continue to customer details.

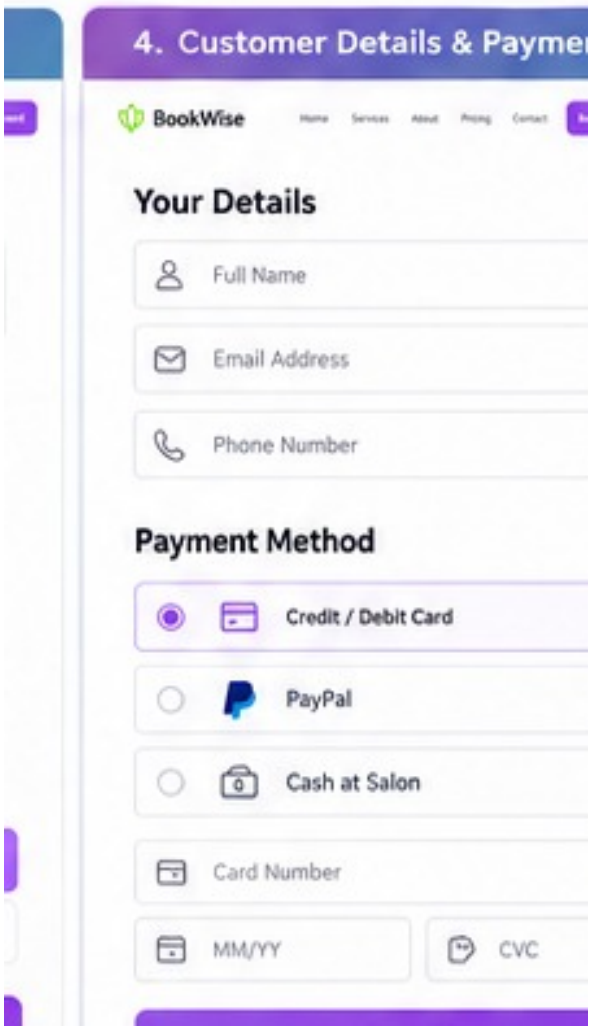
05. Recheck availability on the server when the customer confirms.

Booking constraints

The calendar respects salon timezone, business opening hours, each stylist schedule, appointment duration, optional buffers, holidays, and cancellation lead time. Never trust a time slot simply because a customer saw it on screen.

06 / Customer details and payment

Keep forms short, transparent and trustworthy.



Form fields

Name, email, optional phone, service, stylist, date/time and an optional note. Show a clear booking summary before the final click. Validate inputs on the client for usability **and** on the server for security.

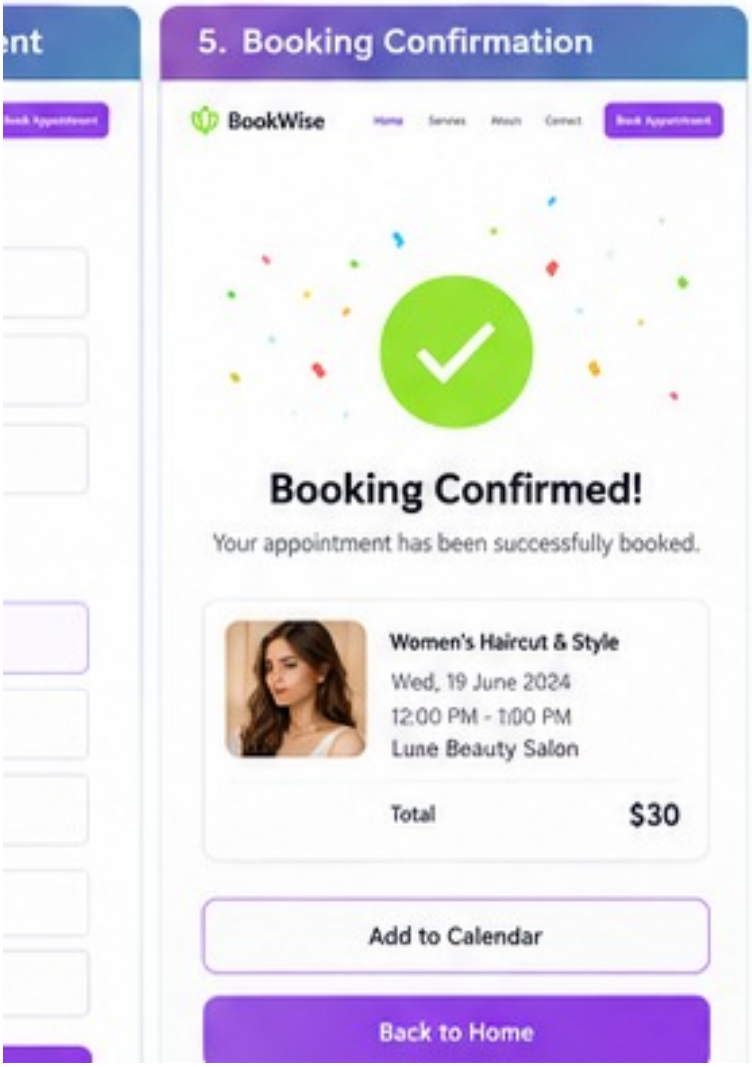
Payment approach for a free MVP

Recommended: Pay at salon. This avoids card storage, payment-gateway integration and transaction fees in Version 1. Mark booking as “payment due at salon”; do not falsely show it as paid.

Optional later: use a reputable payment provider’s hosted checkout, and verify payment by a signed webhook. Payment processors normally charge fees even when their SDK is free. Never store card number or CVV in your database.

07 / Booking confirmation

Make the result unmistakable.



What the confirmation shows

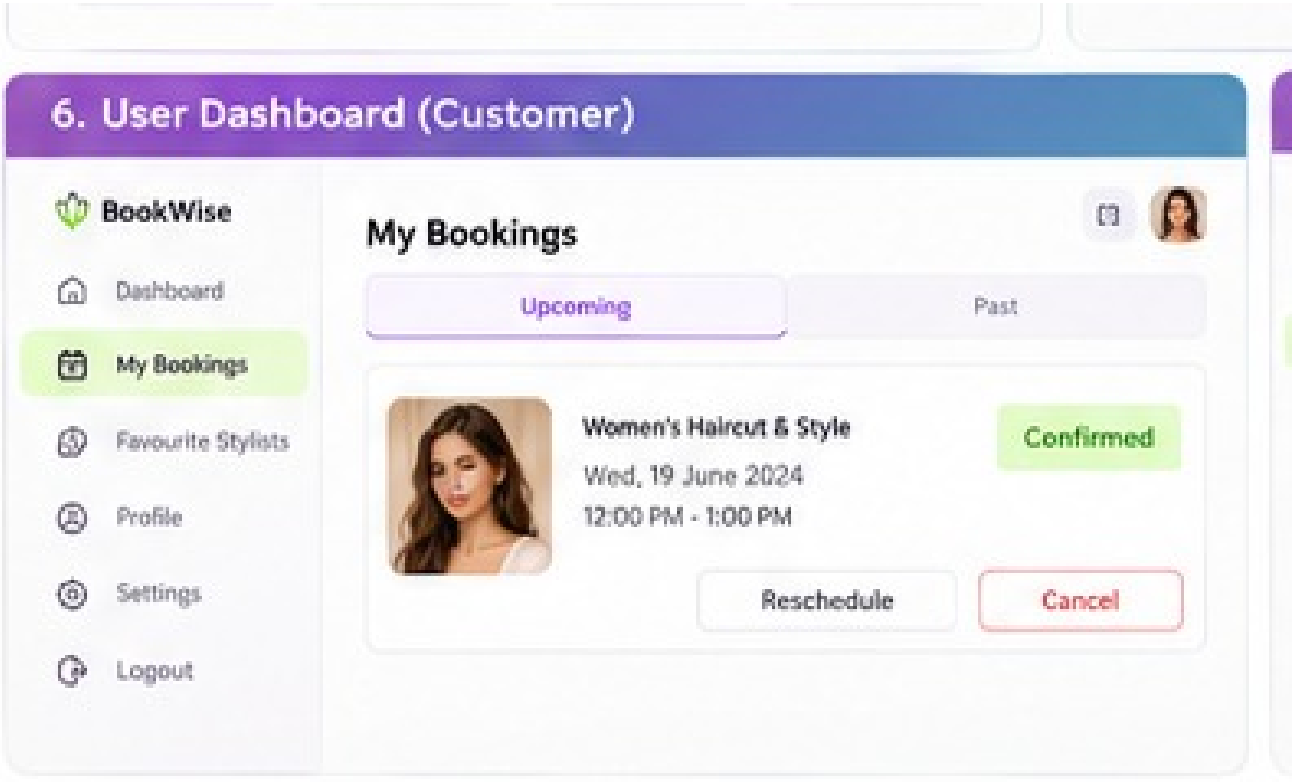
- Booking reference, salon name, service, stylist, start/end time and timezone.
- Price and payment method (for example, “Pay at salon”).
- Booking state: Pending, Confirmed, Completed or Cancelled.
- Add-to-calendar file/link, where supported; optional email confirmation.
- Simple buttons: View My Bookings, Reschedule and Cancel when permitted.

Failure states

If another customer books the slot first, do **not** show a success page. Explain that the chosen slot is unavailable and ask the customer to select another.

08 / Customer account

Let people manage their own appointments.



Customer pages

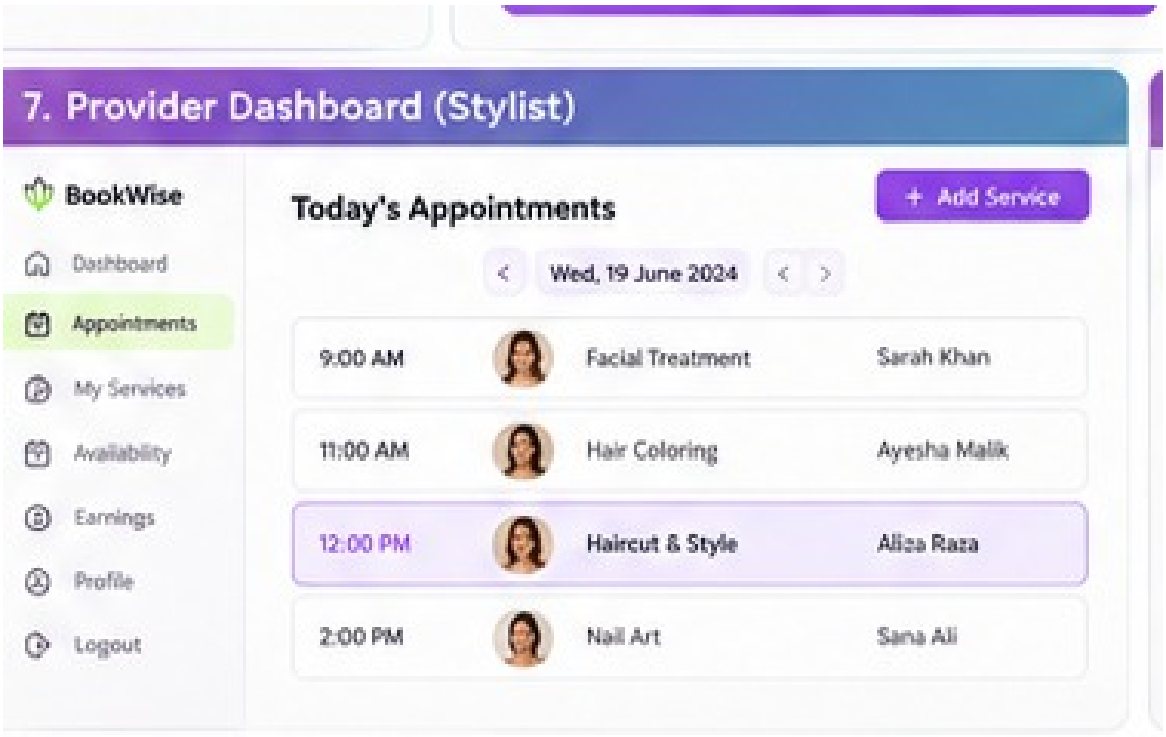
- Sign up, sign in, email verification and password reset.
- My Bookings: upcoming, completed and cancelled bookings.
- Booking detail: exact service, provider, location, price and status.
- Reschedule: choose a new valid slot and confirm the change.
- Cancel: show salon cancellation policy before completing the request.
- Account settings: personal information, session logout and account deletion request.

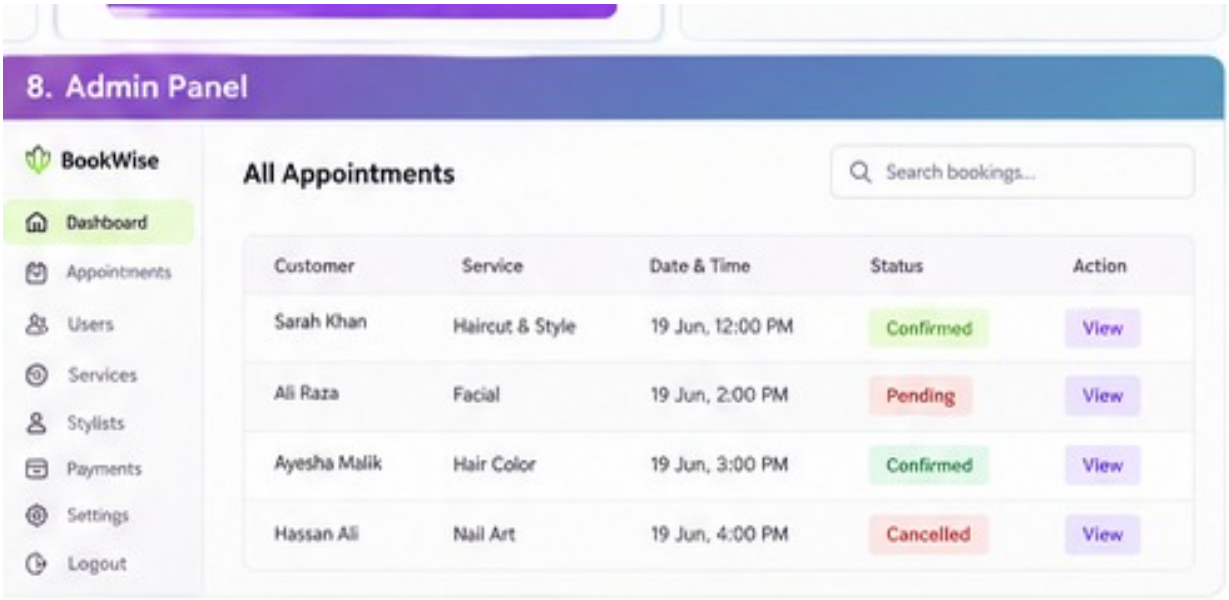
User-handling essentials

Guests may browse. Authentication is required before managing appointments. Customers can access only their own booking records, including when an ID appears in a URL. Give helpful feedback for failed forms and expired sessions.

09 / Stylist and admin dashboards

Simple management, separated by role.

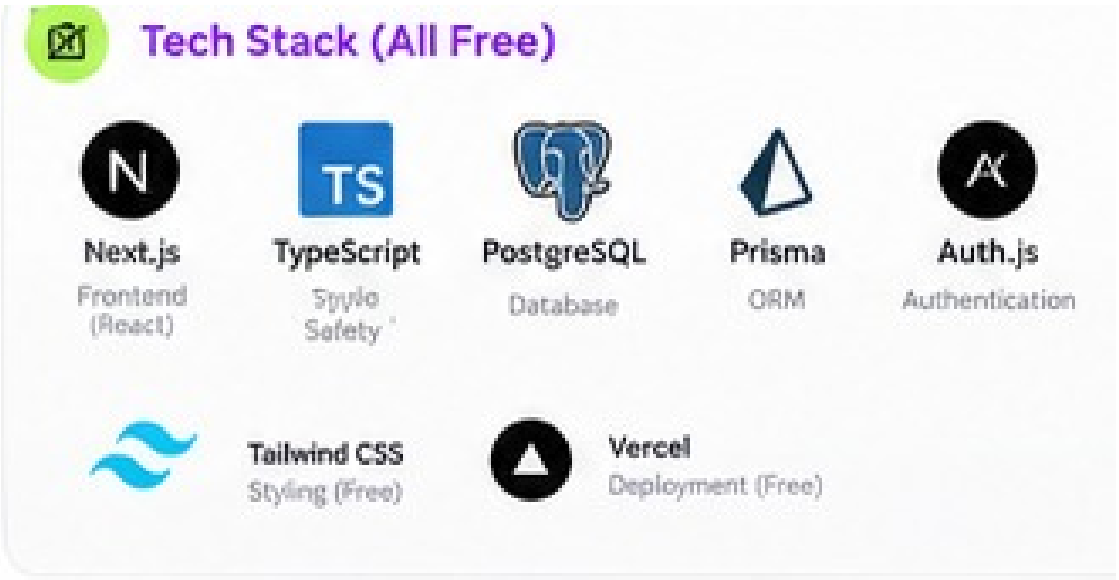




Stylists see assigned upcoming bookings and their own approved availability. Admins see all bookings, staff calendars, customer contacts, services, opening hours and blocked days. Updates to schedules should invalidate newly unavailable slots.

10 / Free technology stack

A realistic stack with no mandatory software licence fees.





Area	Free-first choice	Notes
Frontend	Next.js + TypeScript	One responsive codebase, SEO-friendly pages.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Small reusable components; no paid UI kit.
Backend	Next.js server functions / route handlers	Validate on server; no separate API hosting needed.
Database	Neon Postgres free plan	Check current quotas and availability.
ORM	Prisma	Open-source ORM; standard migrations.
Authentication	Auth.js + secure sessions	Provider/config and hosting limits still apply.
Deployment	Vercel Hobby	Useful for permitted personal/non-commercial use; review terms for a live commercial salon.
Version control	Git + GitHub free	Track code, issues and backups.
Emails (optional)	Provider free tier when available	Usage caps and sender verification may apply.

A live for-profit salon should verify whether its use qualifies for each hosting plan. If Vercel Hobby terms do not fit, use a permitted commercial plan or another provider; do not assume commercial operation is free.

11 / Database explained

Each table stores one clear type of information.



Table	Example fields / purpose
Users	id, name, email, password_hash (if applicable), role, created_at
Staff	id, user_id, bio, active; stylist information
Services	id, name, duration_minutes, price, active
StaffServices	staff_id, service_id; who can perform each service
Availability	staff_id, weekday, start_time, end_time, timezone
TimeOff	staff_id, start_at, end_at, reason; breaks, leave and closures
Bookings	id, customer_id, staff_id, service_id, start_at, end_at, status, quoted_price
AuditLog	actor_id, action, booking_id, timestamp; useful changes history

Store dates correctly

Store appointment timestamps in UTC and salon timezone separately (for example, Asia/Karachi). Convert for display. Use a fixed amount/currency type for prices, not floating-point numbers.

12 / Prevent double booking

This is the most important backend rule.

Server-side booking rule

01. Receive service, stylist and requested start time from logged-in customer.

02. Fetch authoritative service duration and calculate end time on server.

03. Check availability, leave periods, open hours and no conflicting confirmed/pending-held booking.

04. Perform overlap check and booking insert **atomically in the database**.

05. Commit the booking, then send the result. On conflict, reject with a clear “slot taken” message.

Exact overlap logic

An appointment overlaps an existing one when **new_start < existing_end** AND **new_end > existing_start**. Exclude cancelled bookings. Include temporary reservations if used.

Database-level protection

A normal “check, then insert” in application code can race under simultaneous requests. In PostgreSQL, use an exclusion constraint on the staff member and a timestamp range for active bookings, with carefully designed status handling. Alternatively use a properly locked serialized transaction. Use the same approach during rescheduling. This must be tested with two simultaneous requests.

Slot generation

A 9:00 to 17:00 shift does not mean every possible appointment fits. For a 60-minute service, 16:30 must not be offered. Include buffers, meal breaks, leave, appointments and the salon booking lead time.

Status lifecycle

Pending → Confirmed → Completed; Pending/Confirmed → Cancelled. “No-show” may be added. Authorize who can change each status. If payment is due at salon, it is a separate payment state.

13 / Security, privacy and accounts

Safe defaults are part of the MVP.



- Use HTTPS and secure, HttpOnly cookies for session authentication; protect against CSRF where relevant.
- Hash passwords with a modern password-hashing function through a maintained auth solution.
- Implement role-based access on **every** server action and endpoint, not just hidden buttons.
- Check resource ownership: customers only see their bookings; stylists only see assigned records.
- Use Prisma parameterized queries, input validation, rate limiting and safe error responses.
- Keep secrets in environment variables, never in source control or the browser bundle.
- Limit personal information collected; define retention and deletion rules.
- Do not log passwords, session tokens, payment data or private customer notes.
- Backup database data and practice restoring it; free-plan backup tools vary.

User experience of failures

Show clear messages for wrong credentials, expired sessions, invalid date, unavailable slot, permission denied and server problems. Avoid revealing whether a specific email is registered during password recovery.

14 / Responsiveness, speed and accessibility

The website must feel light on budget phones and slow connections.

Performance budget

- Use optimized WebP/AVIF photography, correctly sized images and lazy loading below the first screen.
- Avoid heavy sliders, autoplay videos, large animations and unnecessary client JavaScript.
- Render public page content on the server where useful; load interactive calendar code only where needed.
- Keep UI components small, avoid large dependencies and use caching carefully (never cache private bookings publicly).
- Aim for strong Core Web Vitals; test on actual mobile connections, not desktop only.

Breakpoints

Width	Expected layout
Mobile (up to 639px)	Single-column page, accessible menu, wide booking buttons, readable form fields.
Tablet (640–1023px)	Flexible cards, calendar that fits without sideways scrolling.
Desktop (1024px+)	Comfortable multi-column service grid, booking summary beside calendar.

Accessibility

Use semantic headings, descriptive form labels, keyboard-operated date/time controls, visible focus indicators and adequate contrast. Do not use color alone to indicate whether a slot is available. Provide descriptive alt text for meaningful images.

15 / Testing checklist

Test correctness as well as appearance.

Test group	What to verify
Accounts	Registration, login, logout, password recovery and expired sessions.
Permissions	Customer A cannot read Customer B booking; stylist cannot access another stylist data.
Bookings	Valid slots, blocked time, buffers, timezone and time-off exclusions.
Concurrency	Two customers booking same stylist/time: exactly one succeeds.
Changes	Reschedule conflicts, cancellation windows, staff absence and status edits.
Inputs	Malformed IDs, invalid date, missing fields, script injection and rate limits.
Mobile	320px/375px/768px/desktop, touch targets and keyboard navigation.
Speed	Run Lighthouse and check image sizes and slow-network behavior.
Recovery	Database migration safety, backups and user-friendly outage errors.

Tools that cost nothing to install

Vitest for unit tests; Playwright for browser testing; Next.js linting and TypeScript for quality checks; Chrome Lighthouse and browser developer tools for performance; GitHub Actions within free usage allowances.

Test the hardest scenario

Fire two booking requests simultaneously for the same stylist/time slot. One must be confirmed and the other must receive a conflict response. Repeat for rescheduling and cancellations.

16 / Build and deploy step by step

Ship a dependable first version before extras.

01. Create a GitHub repository and Next.js + TypeScript project.

02. Add brand styles and reusable Header, Footer, Button, ServiceCard and Calendar components.

03. Build Home, Services, Service Detail and Contact pages.

04. Create Postgres database, Prisma models and migrations.

05. Add Auth.js login and server-enforced Customer / Stylist / Admin roles.

06. Build time-slot generation and atomic double-booking prevention.

07. Add customer booking flow: service → calendar → details → confirmation.

08. Add customer bookings, cancellation and rescheduling.

09. Add stylist availability and admin booking/status/service management.

10. Write unit/integration/browser tests and test concurrent requests.

11. Deploy the site to a hosting tier allowed for intended use; add environment secrets in hosting settings.

12. Test production flows, configure monitoring and take a recoverable database backup.

Basic environment variables

A database connection string, authentication secret and app base URL. Any optional email or payment provider credentials belong on the server only. Never paste these values in client-side code or GitHub.

Good Version 2 ideas

Real review moderation, optional email/SMS reminders, waitlist, deposits through hosted payment checkout, multiple locations, provider-side analytics and iCal export. Each adds maintenance cost and should be considered separately.

17 / Pages to build

A complete sitemap in beginner-friendly language.

Public website	Customer area	Salon/staff area
Home	Register / Login	Stylist dashboard
Services and service details	My bookings	Manage availability
Stylist profiles	Booking details	Assigned bookings
About salon	Reschedule / Cancel	Admin calendar
Gallery and Contact	Profile / Settings	Manage services / staff
Policies and FAQ	Booking confirmation	Users / reports / settings

Suggested project folders

app/ public routes and protected areas; **components/** reusable visual elements; **lib/** database, security and slot rules; **prisma/** schema/migrations; **tests/** unit and end-to-end tests; **public/** compressed static images.

Simple acceptance criteria

- A new customer can book within a few steps on a phone.
- Stylist and admin see the new appointment correctly.
- Overlapping confirmed appointments for the same stylist cannot exist.
- Each role sees only authorized information.
- Forms are understandable, site loads quickly, and booking failures are recoverable.

18 / Design reference gallery

These are inspiration images supplied by you, not assets to copy without rights.



Luxury clinic layout: soft hero and appointment calendar.



Form-focused appointment layout and visual hierarchy.



Salon home page, services, trust elements and booking call-to-action.



Compact mobile booking, date selection and confirmation.

19 / Final guidance

Keep the first release focused, useful and easy to maintain.

BookWise is a lightweight full-stack salon booking website with a customer booking experience, stylist dashboard and salon admin controls. The priority is **reliable scheduling**, not visual complexity.

Build first

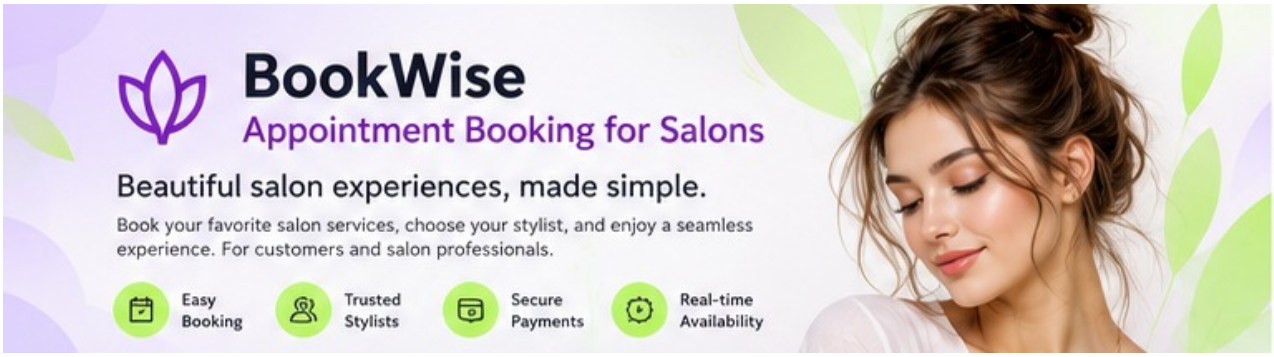
Responsive home and services, login, staff hours, secure book / reschedule / cancel operations, protected dashboards, database conflict prevention, and basic testing.

Add later

Paid bookings, reminders, loyalty, reviews and multi-branch management only after the free MVP is working properly.

Free-tier reality check

Frameworks and libraries can be free, but hosting providers impose quotas and terms. Domain registration, transactional email at volume, commercial deployment and payment processing may cost money. Always check the provider’s latest plan and eligibility before launch.



BookWise - project plan and original concept screen mockups. Created October 2026. Prices, logos, profiles and UI labels visible inside concept images are illustrative placeholders.